

SERMON SEVEN · GOD'S ROAD TO FINANCIAL FREEDOM SERIES

HOW MONEY RESPONDS

Systems · Service · Value · Solutions

PROVERBS 18:16

A man's gift maketh room for him, and bringeth him before great men.

INTRODUCTION

Money is not distributed at random. It is not merely a reward for effort, nor a mystery reserved for the fortunate. Scripture reveals money as a responsive resource — it moves toward specific, identifiable conditions. As we close this series on God's Road to Financial Freedom, we turn from principles of stewardship to the practical question every believer eventually asks: what actually causes money to flow toward a person, a family, or a ministry? The Word gives us four consistent answers: money responds to systems, to service, to value, and to solutions.

PREACHER'S NOTE

Open by asking the congregation: "Have you ever wondered why some hardworking people remain poor while others prosper?" Let the tension sit for a moment before moving to the text. This is a good moment for a show of hands or a brief pair-share.

I. Money Responds to Systems

A system is a repeatable structure that keeps producing value whether or not you are personally present. Where there is no system, income is tied to the limits of one person's time and strength. Where a system exists, provision multiplies beyond what one pair of hands could produce.

GENESIS 41:47–49, 53–57

And in the seven plenteous years the earth brought forth by handfuls... And Joseph gathered corn as the sand of the sea, very much, until he left numbering; for it was without number... And all countries came into Egypt to Joseph for to buy corn.

Joseph did not merely predict the famine — he built a system: collection points in every city, standardized storage, and administrative oversight (Genesis 41:34–36, 48). That system did not just save Egypt; it positioned Joseph as second only to Pharaoh, and eventually made Egypt a source of provision for the entire region.

Application for today

- A budget is a system. A savings and giving plan is a system. A business process that runs without your constant supervision is a system.
- Ask: What am I currently doing only with my own hands that could be turned into a repeatable structure?

PREACHER'S NOTE

Illustrate locally: contrast a farmer who sells produce informally at the roadside with one who has organized storage, transport, and a standing buyer network (a SACCO or cooperative model works well in Kericho). Same harvest, different systems, different outcome.

II. Money Responds to Service

In the Kingdom, greatness and reward are tied to service, not status. The world asks, "who is served?" The Kingdom asks, "who serves?" Financially, this principle is remarkably consistent: the more people you serve, and the better you serve them, the more provision follows.

MARK 10:43–45

But whosoever will be great among you, shall be your minister: and whosoever of you will be the chiefest, shall be servant of all. For even the Son of man came not to be ministered unto, but to minister, and to give his life a ransom for many.

Jesus does not present service as a spiritual add-on to ambition; He presents it as the very definition of greatness. Every legitimate form of income, examined honestly, is payment for a service rendered to someone else's need. Poor service caps income; excellent, wide-reaching service expands it.

Application for today

- Excellence is not optional for the believer in business or ministry — it is an act of worship and a magnet for provision.
- Ask: Who am I serving, how well, and how many?

PREACHER'S NOTE

Caution the congregation gently here against a transactional reading — we do not serve merely to be paid. Reward follows service; it is not the motive for it (Colossians 3:23–24 is a useful cross-reference if time allows).

III. Money Responds to Value

Money moves toward value — the competence, skill, character, and quality that a person or an offering carries. Value is not static. It is entrusted, developed, and either multiplied or buried.

MATTHEW 25:20–21

He that had received five talents came and brought other five talents, saying, Lord, thou deliveredst unto me five talents: behold, I have gained beside them five talents more. His lord said unto him, Well done, thou good and faithful servant... I will make thee ruler over many things.

Notice that the servants who increased what they were given were entrusted with more responsibility and more resource. The servant who buried his one talent lost even what he had (v.28–29). Undeveloped value — a gift never sharpened, a skill never trained, a business never improved — remains hidden and unrewarded.

Application for today

- Continuing education, skill-sharpening, and character formation are not delays to financial breakthrough — they are the road to it.
- Ask: What talent, skill, or capacity have I buried instead of developing?

PREACHER'S NOTE

This is a natural point to reference Hosea 4:6 ("my people are destroyed for lack of knowledge") if you want to tie back into earlier sermons in this series on knowledge, skill, and provision.

IV. Money Responds to Solutions

Money gravitates toward problem-solvers. The bigger and more urgent the problem you are positioned to solve, the greater the financial response you can expect.

GENESIS 41:39–41

And Pharaoh said unto Joseph, Forasmuch as God hath shewed thee all this, there is none so discreet and wise as thou art: Thou shalt be over my house, and according unto thy word shall all my people be ruled... See, I have set thee over all the land of Egypt.

Joseph was not elevated because he was righteous in the abstract — Scripture is clear that his promotion came at the exact moment he presented Pharaoh with the solution to a national crisis. This is the same principle behind Proverbs 18:16, our opening text: a gift — a solution someone carries — makes room for them and brings them before great men.

Application for today

- Look around you for unmet needs, inefficiencies, and problems — in your church, your business, your community. That is where opportunity is hiding.
- Ask: What real problem, however small, can I position myself to solve this season?

PREACHER'S NOTE

Strong closing illustration point. You may want to reference Keswick Books & Gifts or a Kericho Town Church ministry as a local example of a solution-oriented venture, if appropriate for the congregation.

SYNTHESIS: HOW THE FOUR WORK TOGETHER

These four are not separate strategies to choose between — they compound. A system delivers service at scale. Service is powered by value. And value is most richly rewarded when it is deliberately aimed at solving a real problem. Joseph's story contains all four at once: a system (storage administration), rendered as service (to Egypt and the surrounding nations), built on value (God-given wisdom and interpretation, Genesis 41:39), aimed at a solution (the famine). That is why his elevation was not an accident, but a pattern we can walk in today.

PERSONAL REFLECTION & DISCUSSION

1. What is one activity in my life that depends entirely on my own presence, which I could begin turning into a system?
2. Where am I serving fewer people, or serving at a lower standard, than I am capable of?
3. What skill or capacity has God entrusted to me that I have left undeveloped?
4. What specific problem — in my home, workplace, church, or community — am I positioned to solve?

CLOSING PRAYER & ALTAR CALL

Father, thank You for showing us that financial breakthrough is not a mystery but a pattern written into Your Word. Forgive us for the systems we never built, the service we withheld, the value we left buried, and the solutions we were too discouraged to offer. Today we ask for grace to build, to serve, to grow, and to solve — for Your glory and for the flourishing of our families, our church, and our nation. In Jesus' name, Amen.

PREACHER'S NOTE

Invite those who sense a specific system, service, skill, or solution God is highlighting to them to come forward or stand where they are for corporate prayer. Consider closing with a brief testimony slot in next week's service from anyone who acts on this word.